TCS CORPORATE WEBSITE

Footer — Authoring Guide

Role / audience	Authoring — Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
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Footer — Authoring Guide

Attribute	Value
Document ID	AUT-C-footer
Audience	Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Purpose	How to add, fill in and check the Footer component
Scope	—
Prerequisites	—
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
Approver	Product Owner (to be confirmed)
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Last updated	13 November 2026
Last validated	13 November 2026
Source files	blocks/footer/README.md, blocks/footer/_footer.json
Related documents	—
Related AEM paths	—

1. Where to see it

- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/campaign-page
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/default-footer-page
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/footer-campaign
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/footer-conversation-canvas
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/footer-default
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/footer-investors
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/investors-page

2. For Content Authors

1. **Open the footer page** of the locale (`references/footer`) or of the area (for example `references/footer-campaign`) in Universal Editor.
2. **Add the block** if the page has none: section › Add › **Footer**.
3. **Open its properties.** Fill in **Conversation Canvas Page** (optional: a page with a Conversation Canvas block, e.g. `references/footer-conversation-canvas`) and **Copyright Text** (use `{year}` for the current year).
4. **Add links** with Add › **Footer Link** inside the Footer block: Link Path (required), Link text, Open in (Same tab / New tab). Reorder them in the content tree; they render in that order.
5. **Social channels** are not in the block: maintain the locale's `data/social-links` sheet (platform, url, icon, sort-order).

6. **Preview** a content page (desktop, tablet, mobile) and check the bar, the Canvas and the social row.
7. **Publish** the footer page, the Conversation Canvas page and, after changes, the Social Links sheet.
8. **Choose the footer for an area (optional):** Page Properties › **Footer** on the area's top page (inherited by child pages; empty: the parent's, else `references/footer`), or the metadata sheet's `footer` column.
9. **Validate** on the published site: the year is current, links reach their pages, new-tab links open a new tab.

Minimum required: Copyright Text or at least one Footer Link. Recommended: 3–6 links, the Canvas page on the locale footer, a `platform` value on every social row. Optional: the Canvas, area footers.

3. Authorable Fields

Footer (`footer`)

Model `footer`; template name "Footer" (the block class AEM renders); children: `footer-link`.

Fields — Footer

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Conversation Canvas Page	`conversationCanvas`	aem-content	No	—	—	A page with the conversation-canvas block (e.g. references/conversation-canvas), shown above the copyright and links	—
Copyright Text	`copyright`	richtext	No	—	—	e.g. ©TATA Consultancy Services {year}; {year} is replaced with the current year	—
Link List	`links`	container (multiple)	No	—	—	Links authored before Footer Link items. Add links with Add (Footer Link) instead.	—
Link List › Link Title	`linkText`	text	No	—	—	—	—
Link List › Link Path	`link`	aem-content	No	—	—	—	—
Link List › Link Type	`linkTarget`	select	No	""	Default (""), Open in new window (`new-window`)	—	—

Footer Link (`footer-link`)

Model `footer-link`; template name "Footer Link" (the block class AEM renders).

Fields — Footer Link

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Link Path	`link`	aem-content	Yes	—	—	—	—
Link text	`linkText`	text	No	—	—	Delivered with `link` (field collapse).	—
Open in	`linkTarget`	select	No	""	Same tab (""), New tab (`new-window`)	—	—

Notes on the significant fields:

- **Conversation Canvas Page.** Loaded as a fragment (`loadFragment`) into `div.footer-canvas` above the bar; a value that can't be loaded or has no sections is skipped. Inside the footer the Canvas loses its own surface, glow and padding; its menu button shows from 600px.
- **Copyright Text.** Rich text kept with its editor instrumentation (`fromCell`); every `{year}` becomes the current four-digit year from the visitor's clock; empty text renders no copyright element.
- **Footer Link (item).** Link Path with its Link text collapsed into one link (AEM delivery rule); Open in New tab sets `target="_blank"` and `rel="noopener noreferrer"` and adds the hidden hint "(opens in a new tab)" (placeholder `opensInNewTab`). Links are plain links (button decoration removed). An item without a link isn't rendered; in Universal Editor it shows as a dashed placeholder (placeholder `itemEditorHint`).
- **Link List (legacy multifield).** Still read: its items render before the Footer Link items. Add links as Footer Link items instead (composite multifields didn't render from content packages, AGENTS.md "Item children").
- **Page property Footer** (`footer`, `models/_page.json`) and the metadata `footer` column choose the footer page (see the Header README for the same inheritance; values cached per browser session, F-35).
- **Social Links sheet.** Rows without `url` are skipped; ordered by numeric `sort-order` (rows without one last, in sheet order). `icon`: a value with `.` or `/` is an image URL; otherwise an icon name in `/icons` (`linkedin`, `x`, `facebook`, `instagram`, `youtube`; `twitter` is an alias of `x`); without an icon and an unknown platform, the label is shown as text. Links to another origin open in a new tab.
- **Accessibility impact.** `nav.footer-links` named "Footer links" (`footerLinks`); social links named "Follow us on {platform}" (`followUsOn`), the list "Follow us" (`followUs`).
- **Data layer impact.** Clicks are reported for the footer components (see Data Layer and Analytics).
- **Additional tab.** The Footer has none (AGENTS.md "Additional tab": all blocks except header and footer).

4. Screenshot-Based Authoring Steps

Authoring Step 1: Open the footer page and add the Footer block

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-authoring-step-1.png

Purpose:
The locale's references/footer page in Universal Editor with the Footer block in its section.

Annotations:
A = Section of the footer page
B = Footer block
C = Footer Link items in the content tree
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Page	`references/footer` (sample `block-library/footer/footer-default`)	The default footer of the locale	Opens as a page
B	Component	Footer	Holds the bar	An empty Footer block

Author action: section › Add › Footer. Expected preview: an empty bar. Business rule: footer pages live in `references/`. Validation: the block appears in the content tree. Common mistake: adding a Footer to a content page (unstyled); resolution: remove it there.

Authoring Step 2: Canvas page and copyright

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-authoring-step-2.png

Purpose:
The Footer properties with Conversation Canvas Page and Copyright Text filled in.

Annotations:
A = Conversation Canvas Page
B = Copyright Text
```

Values to Enter

Call out	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Conversation Canvas Page	`/content/tcs-corp/language-masters/en/block-library/footer/footer-conversation-canvas`	The footer Canvas of the design	"Let's shape what's next, together" above the bar
B	Copyright Text	`© Tata Consultancy Services {year}`	Keeps the year current	"© Tata Consultancy Services 2026" in 2026

Expected published result: the Canvas and the copyright on every page using this footer. Business rule: the Canvas page must be published and contain a Conversation Canvas. Validation: the year shows as the current year. Common mistake: typing the year (it won't update); use `{year}`.

Authoring Step 3: Footer Links

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-authoring-step-3.png

Purpose:
A Footer Link item's properties.

Annotations:
A = Link Path
B = Link text
C = Open in
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Link Path	The privacy notice page	Required	Link target
B	Link text	`Privacy & Terms`	Visible text	"Privacy & Terms" in the bar
C	Open in	Same tab	Site page	Opens in the same tab

Add `Cookie policy` and `Accessibility` the same way (sample footer-default). Author action: Footer block › Add › Footer Link. Expected preview: links at the right of the copyright (below it on mobile). Business rule: an item without a link isn't rendered on the site. Validation: each link opens its page. Common mistake: leaving Link Path empty (dashed placeholder in the editor, nothing on the site).

Authoring Step 4: A link opening a new tab

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-authoring-step-4.png

Purpose:
A Footer Link with Open in = New tab (sample footer-investors).

Annotations:
A = Link Path (external)
B = Open in: New tab
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Link Path	`https://investors.example.com/` (library sample)	External site	Link to the other site
B	Link text	`Investor relations`	Visible text	Link text
C	Open in	New tab	Leave the TCS site open	`target="_blank"`, hint "(opens in a new tab)" for screen readers

Validation: the published link has `rel="noopener noreferrer"`. Common mistake: new tabs for site pages; keep Same tab for them.

Authoring Step 5: Area footer

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-authoring-step-5.png

Purpose:
Page Properties of an area's top page with the Footer field set.

Annotations:
A = Footer
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Footer	`references/footer-campaign`	Campaign footer	The area's pages show the campaign footer

Validation: a child page in a new private window. Common mistake: a typo in the path: the page footer then shows only the social row (no fallback to `references/footer`).

5. Variations

Default locale footer

- **Purpose:** the footer of every page without a Footer value: `/{locale}/references/footer`.
- **Fields / configuration:** none on the content page.
- **Rendering:** the footer page's sections in `footer > div.footer > div`, then `ul.footer-social`.
- **Desktop / tablet / mobile:** see Responsive Behavior.
- **Accessibility / data layer:** `<footer>` landmark; clicks on `footer-1` / `footer-2`.

- **Personalization / fallback:** none; a failing footer page leaves the social row.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-default-desktop.png

Purpose:
A content page ending with the default footer at 1440px.

Annotations:
A = Footer Canvas
B = Footer bar
C = Social icons
```

Area-specific footer

- **Purpose:** another footer page for an area or campaign (`references/footer-campaign`).
- **Configuration:** Page Properties › Footer on the area's top page, or the metadata `footer` column.
- **Rendering:** as the default; only the footer page differs; the Social Links are added to every footer page.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-campaign-desktop.png

Purpose:
A campaign page ending with the campaign footer (no Canvas).

Annotations:
A = Copyright
B = Campaign links
```

Footer bar only (no Canvas)

- **Purpose:** a compact footer.
- **Fields:** Copyright Text and Footer Links; Conversation Canvas Page empty.
- **Rendering:** `div.footer-bar` only; no minimum height.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-bar-only-mobile.png

Purpose:
The bar at 390px: the copyright above the links.

Annotations:
A = Copyright
B = Links
```

Footer with Conversation Canvas

- **Purpose:** the design's footer: the Canvas above the bar.
- **Fields:** Conversation Canvas Page.
- **Rendering:** `div.footer-canvas` with the Canvas page's sections; the footer gets a minimum height (50rem, 59.75rem from 600px, 50.125rem from 1200px) and the bar sits at its bottom; title 3.25rem (6rem from 600px), buttons stacked below 600px, the Canvas menu button from 600px.
- **Data layer:** the Canvas is its own component; it is the footer stop of the floating journey.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-canvas-mobile.png

Purpose:
The footer Canvas at 390px (see Visual Reference).

Annotations:
A = Title
B = Search
```

Social links (icons, images, text)

- **Purpose:** the locale's channels from the Social Links sheet.
- **Rendering:** `ul.footer-social[aria-label="Follow us"] > li > a` with `span.icon.icon-{name}` (1.5rem), an image for an icon URL (`alt=""`), or the visible label text; the label "Follow us on {platform}" is visually hidden behind an icon.
- **Accessibility:** external links open a new tab and say so in the label.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-social-fallbacks-desktop.png

Purpose:
A social row with an /icons icon, an image icon and a text label.

Annotations:
A = Icon
B = Image icon
C = Text label
```

Footer Link opening in a new tab

- **Purpose:** an external destination.
- **Fields:** Open in = New tab.
- **Rendering:** `target="_blank"`, `rel="noopener noreferrer"`, hidden " (opens in a new tab)".

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
footer-new-tab-desktop.png

Purpose:
The investors footer with "Investor relations" opening a new tab.

Annotations:
A = Investor relations link
```

6. Complete Authoring Example

Scenario: the `/en` footer with the Canvas, three policy links and the social channels.

Field	Example value	Guidance
Page	`/content/tcs-corp/us/en/references/footer`	The locale default
Conversation Canvas Page	`references/footer-conversation-canvas`	A page with one Conversation Canvas

Field	Example value	Guidance
Copyright Text	© Tata Consultancy Services {year}	Keep {year} in translations
Footer Link 1	Privacy & Terms → the privacy page, Same tab	
Footer Link 2	Cookie policy → the cookie policy page, Same tab	
Footer Link 3	Accessibility → the accessibility page, Same tab	
Social Links sheet	LinkedIn / profile URL / linkedin / 1, …	Full https URLs

Steps: author the block and its items, publish the footer page and the Canvas page, check the Social Links sheet is published.

Expected output: the Canvas, the bar and the icons on every /en page without its own Footer value. Responsive: see the table below. Accessibility: nav "Footer links", named social links, new-tab hints. Analytics: bar clicks on footer-2, social clicks on footer-1, Canvas clicks on its own component. Personalization fallback: none.

Pre-publish checklist:

- ☐ {year} in the copyright.
- ☐ Every Footer Link has a Link Path and a text.
- ☐ New tab only for external links.
- ☐ Canvas page published; Social Links rows have url and platform.
- ☐ Checked at 390px, 1024px, 1440px.

7. Content and Asset Guidelines

- **Copyright.** One line; the copyright column is at least 19.375rem wide (links go below it on narrow screens).
- **Links.** Navigational nouns ("Privacy & Terms", "Cookie policy"), short and unique.
- **Canvas.** See the Conversation Canvas README; its title shows at 6rem from 600px.
- **Icons.** /icons names need no upload; image icons display at 1.5rem × 1.5rem (square SVG / PNG).
- **Alt text.** Social images are decorative (alt=""); the link name comes from the platform.
- **Tags and metadata.** No tags; the footer metadata chooses the footer page.
- **Min / max items.** No verified technical limit was identified.
- **Loading.** The footer page, Social Links and placeholders load in parallel in the lazy phase; the Canvas page is a further fragment request.
- **Missing assets.** An icon name without a file in /icons gives a broken icon (F-16).

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
Footer shows only social icons	Footer page not published or wrong Footer value	Network: {footer}.plain.html status; <meta name="footer"> of the page and parents	Publish / correct the path	Bar visible
{year} shown or wrong year	Year typed, or {year} misspelled; visitor's clock	Inspect the copyright text	Use {year}	Current year
Social links missing or in the wrong order	Sheet not published, rows without url, sort-order not numeric	Open /{locale}/data/social-links.json	Fix and publish the sheet	Row in order
Broken social icon	Icon name without a file in /icons (F-16)	Inspect span.icon-{name}	Use a supported name or an image URL	Icon visible

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
Canvas missing	Canvas page unpublished or without content	Network for the Canvas page	Publish it	Canvas visible
Footer unstyled	Footer block placed on a content page	Inspect the block's position	Remove it from the content page	—
Wrong footer in an area	Parent value cached (F-35) or set on the wrong page	New private window; check the parents	Set Footer on the area top page	Area footer

Evidence to collect: page URL, the `footer` meta values, network status of the footer, Canvas and Social Links requests, console errors, screenshots. No cookies or tokens.

9. Screenshots

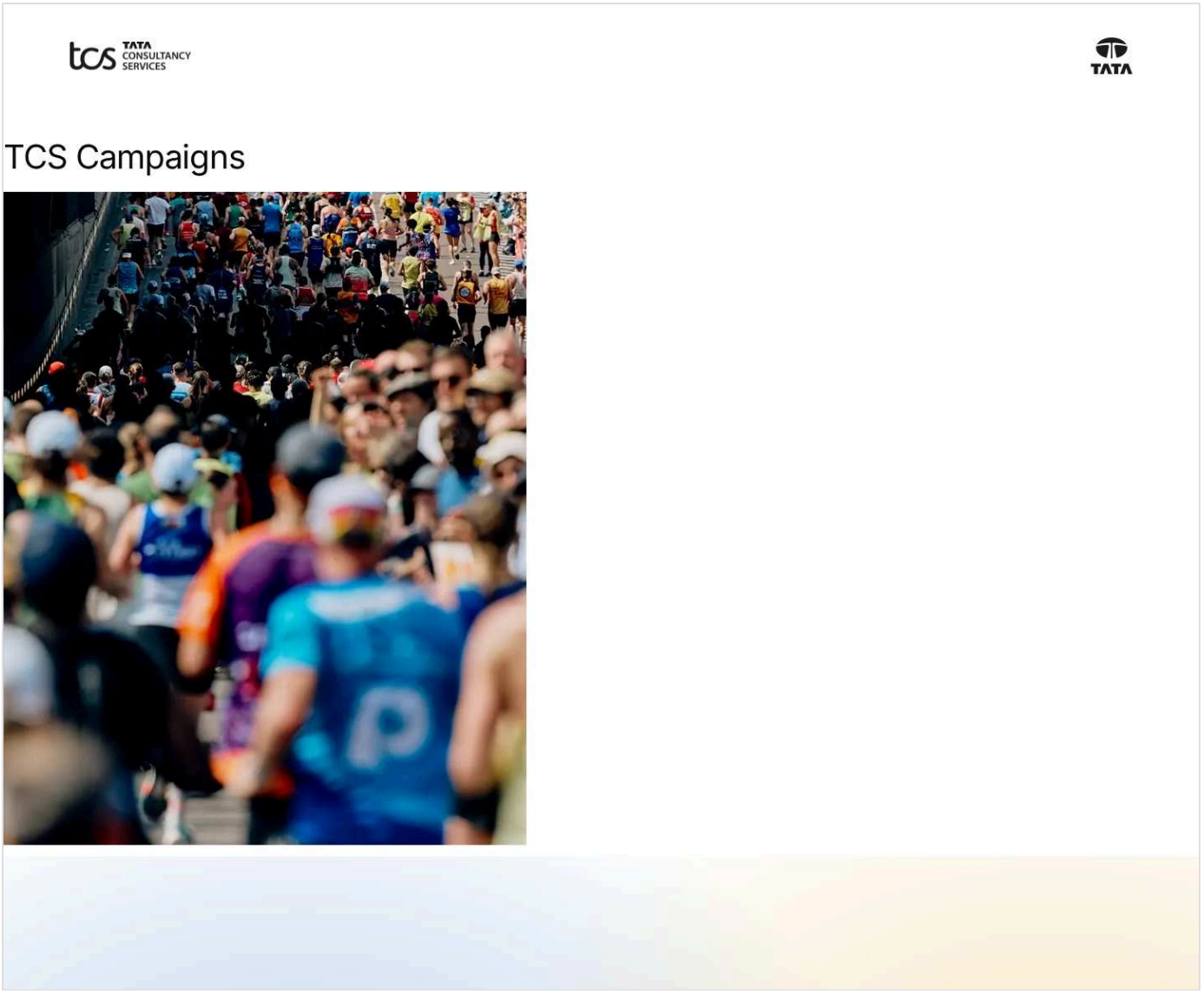


Figure: Footer as published (block library) — desktop 1440 × 900 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/campaign-page, captured 2026-11-08).



Figure: Footer as published (block library) — mobile 375 × 812 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/footer/campaign-page, captured 2026-11-08).

> **Screenshot required**
>
> - Required screen: Footer dialog in Universal Editor (every tab, including Additional)
> - Required role/access: AEM Sites author with Universal Editor (content author)

> - Required navigation steps: AEM Sites console > /content/tcs-corp/language-masters/en > open a page in Universal Editor
> - Reason unavailable: No AEM author access in the documentation program (access blocker AB-01)
> - Owner: Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
> - Target completion date: To be confirmed

10. Known limitations

- Universal Editor screenshots are placeholders: no author access in this program.

11. Open items

- None.

12. Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	13 November 2026	Delivery team (documentation program)	First version of the role-specific documentation (master documentation prompt), generated from the repository and the published reference pages